



Arrow Biometric Fingerprint Identification Lock

This is sort of a dream device for the more forgetful of us. Never again will you find yourself locked out of the house, office or even your car.

The Arrow biometric fingerprint identification lock is powered by batteries, that will give you enough advanced warning, so don't worry you won't be locked out because the batteries died!

This device will fit perfectly into the future, as we move towards more secure ways of transacting, whether it's paying a bill or opening a door. We can see this device being utilised not just in houses, but also for cars, safes, personal lockers and even at supermarkets—it can make identity theft and the use of stolen credit information a thing of the past.

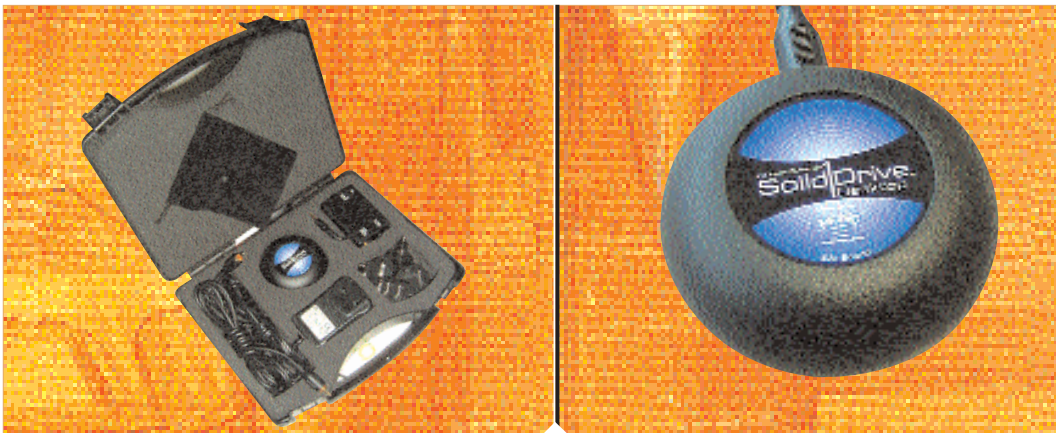
A more creative line of thought could see them implemented in schools and colleges, to make sure that only students authorised to enter a classroom can do so. It could do away with 'cheating by proxy' (where someone else appears on your behalf, usually a smarter someone!), and even help in maintaining foolproof attendance records! See www.arrowvision.us for more details.

Solid Drive Speaker Drivers

Turn a wall or a table into a speaker. Sound unbelievable? Believe it! Solid Drive speaker drivers can make any flat solid object into a speaker, by vibrating it to produce sound. Even windows can become speakers, or the door, or a conference table—use your imagination!

The best use for it though, would be inside the walls of your converged house, so that you get a true, complete surround experience, and no speakers are ever visible.

See www.soliddrive.com for more details.



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The House

As you can see, most of the devices mentioned here are hardly components of a science-fiction flick. If you have enough money, you can have the home of the future today! The good news is that as these devices become more popular, the prices will fall, and all of us will be able to afford the converged home of our dreams!

The home of the future will blur the existing lines that we draw between different types of devices. And, if at all we're forced to divide the digital content, it can only be into audio and video—only because that's how we as humans experience multimedia content.

The demarcations between PCs, PDAs, TVs, audio systems, etc., will be obliterated forever, as it isn't really important to us what we're interfacing with; what's more important is that we get the content we desire, and are able to compute and communicate via the audio-visual devices at will.

The box *"Believe It Or Not"* on page 60 points you towards some more devices that we can expect to see in the near future. Technology, of late, has become boring. It's true! All we could see happening over the past decade was CPUs getting faster, and hard disk sizes increasing, but nothing groundbreaking. Now, thankfully, we seem to be past this stagnation, and have started climbing again—the next 10 years promise tons of exciting changes, not just in technology, but in the way we lead our lives! ■

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